Internet & SaaS (ZIA)

Best Practices for Testing and Rolling Out SSL/TLS Inspection

As a best practice, Zscaler recommends that you enable SSL/TLS Inspection in a small location or test lab before enabling it on all locations in your organization. This allows you to test your deployment of SSL/TLS Inspection with a select number of users.

To enable SSL/TLS Inspection, first deploy the Zscaler or custom intermediate root certificate. Then, enable SSL/TLS Inspection for the location or sublocation you are using for testing.

Testing SSL/TLS Inspection

Before testing SSL/TLS Inspection, define the set of users you want to use for testing. For example, you can choose users from the IT department, such as application authors and owners, support staff members, proxy team members, or security team members. You can also choose managers and end users from non-IT departments.

To test SSL/TLS Inspection:

1. Compile a list of the websites and applications that your organization uses for everyday operations. Remember to include vendor sites and applications.
2. Enable SSL/TLS Inspection for the websites and applications from the list by configuring the SSL/TLS Inspection policy, and then have the users test them.

   > When you are configuring the SSL/TLS Inspection policy, you are specifying the URL categories or applications that you do not want the service to inspect. For example, if you want to enable SSL/TLS Inspection for the Legal Liability categories only, then select the **Do Not Inspect** action for all the URL categories except the Legal Liability categories in your SSL/TLS Inspection rule. The Zscaler service does not perform SSL/TLS Inspection on the specified URL categories, but does perform SSL/TLS Inspection on the Legal Liability categories.

3. You might need to exempt some sites for SSL/TLS Inspection permanently, or you might need to report sites to Zscaler Support to identify the cause of failure.

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Zscaler recommends not to exempt the **Miscellaneous or Unknown** category for SSL/TLS Inspection if the traffic forwarded to Zscaler uses transparent proxy mode. In transparent mode, policies on both SNI and IP addresses are evaluated for exemption from SSL/TLS Inspection. Exempting SSL/TLS Inspection for the **Miscellaneous or Unknown** category exempts almost all traffic from SSL/TLS Inspection as most IP addresses are categorized as miscellaneous or unknown. However, in the case of explicit traffic forwarding, Zscaler evaluates the policies only based on SNI and does not exempt traffic from SSL/TLS Inspection based on IP address categories. To learn more, see Choosing Traffic Forwarding Methods.

4. After testing the list of websites and applications, test SSL/TLS Inspection for the URL categories. As a best practice, Zscaler recommends that you enable SSL/TLS Inspection for only certain URL categories at a time, and include the rest of the categories in the list of URL categories for which SSL/TLS transactions are not to be decrypted. Then, when your organization is ready, enable SSL/TLS Inspection for all URL categories.

   Some organizations choose to bypass SSL/TLS Inspection for Finance and Health URL categories due to privacy concerns. Zscaler recommends that you enable SSL/TLS Inspection for all URL categories.

   Enable and test SSL/TLS Inspection for the URL categories in the following order of phases:

   URL Categories in Phase 1

Phase 1
Adult Themes
Alcohol/Tobacco
Anonymizer
Computer Hacking
Copyright Infringement
Drugs
Gambling
Mature Humor
Militancy/Hate and Extremism

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Newly Registered and Observed Domains
Non-Categorizable
Nudity
Other Adult Material
Other Illegal or Questionable
Other Security
Peer-to-Peer Site
Pornography
Questionable
Social Networking Adult
Spyware/Adware
Tasteless
Violence
Weapons/Bombs
Blogs
Classifieds
Custom Encrypted Content
Discussion Forums
DNS Over HTTPS Services
Dynamic DNS Host
File Convertors
FileHost
General AI and ML Applications
Generative AI and ML Applications
Image Host
Internet Services

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Lifestyle
Marijuana
Military
Miscellaneous or Unknown
Newly Revived Domains
News and Media
Online and Other Games
Online Chat
Other Drugs
Other Miscellaneous
Portals
Profanity
Radio
Remote Access Tools
Safe Search Engine
Shareware Download
Streaming Media
Web Search
Webmail

Before testing the URL categories in phase 2, remember to keep SSL/TLS inspection enabled for the URL categories in phase 1.

URL Categories in Phase 2

Phase 2
Adult Sex Education
Alt or New Age
Alternate Lifestyle

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Art and Culture
Body Art
Continuing Education/Colleges
Corporate Marketing
Cult
Dining and Restaurant
Entertainment
Family Issues
Government
History
Hobbies and Leisure
Job/Employment Search
K-12
K-12 Sex Education
Lingerie/Bikini
Music
Online Auctions
Online Shopping
Other Education
Other Entertainment/Recreation
Other Games
Other Government and Politics
Other Information Technology
Other Internet Communication
Other Religion
Other Shopping and Auctions

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Other Social and Family Issues
Other Society and Lifestyle
Politics
Radio Stations
Real Estate
Reference Sites
Science/Technology
Social Issues
Social Networking
Social Networking Games
Special Interests/Social Organizations
Sports
Television/Movies
Traditional Religion
Translators
Travel
Vehicles
Online Trading and Brokerage
Other Business and Economy
Professional Services
Video Streaming
Web Conferencing
Web Host

Before testing the URL categories in phase 3, remember to keep SSL/TLS inspection enabled for the URL categories in phases 1 and 2.

- URL Categories in Phase 3

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Phase 3
Advertising
Blogs
Classifieds
Content Delivery Networks (CDNs)
Discussion Forums
File Host
Finance
Health
Image Host
Insurance
Internet Services
Miscellaneous or Unknown
MS O365 Allow
MS O365 Default
News and Media
Online Chat
Operating System and Software Updates
Other Business and Economy
Portals
Professional Services
Remote Access
Safe Search Engine
Shareware Download
Streaming Media
Web Host

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Web Search
Webmail
Zscaler Proxy IPs

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